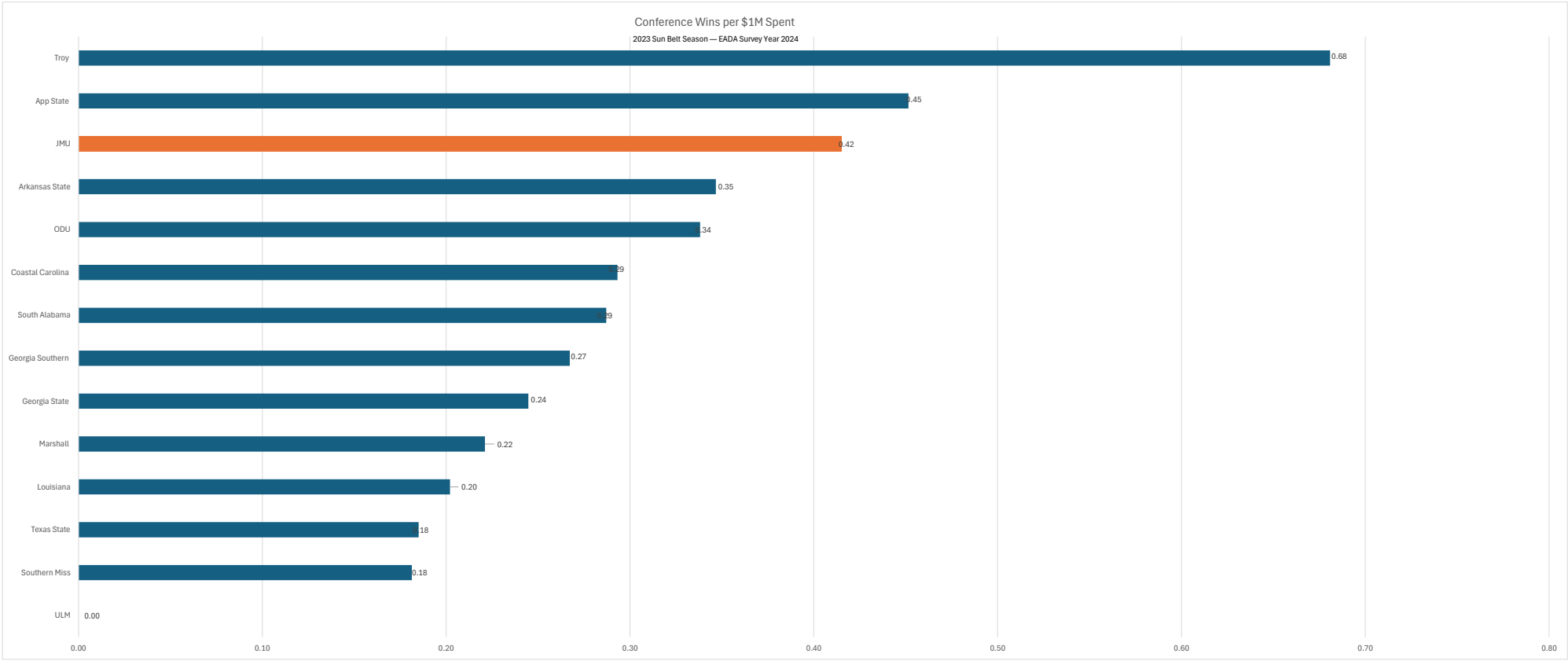
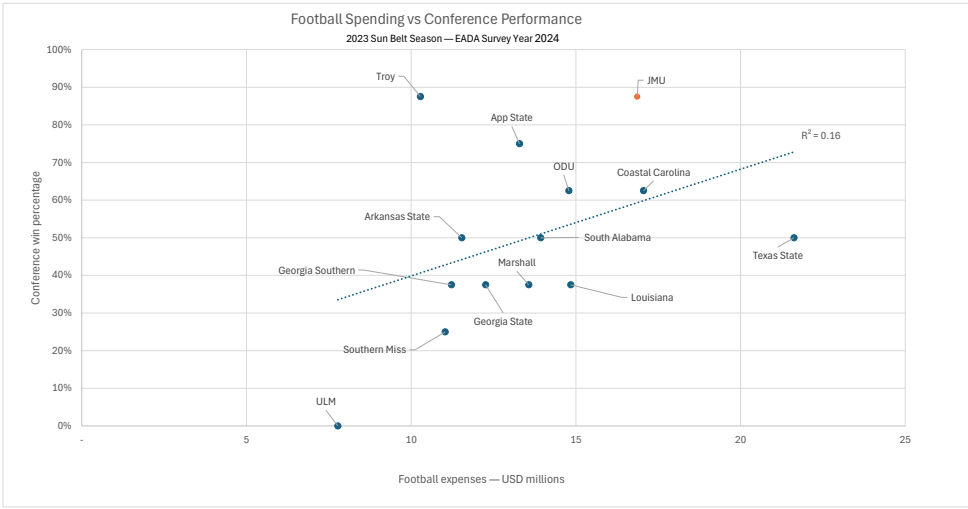
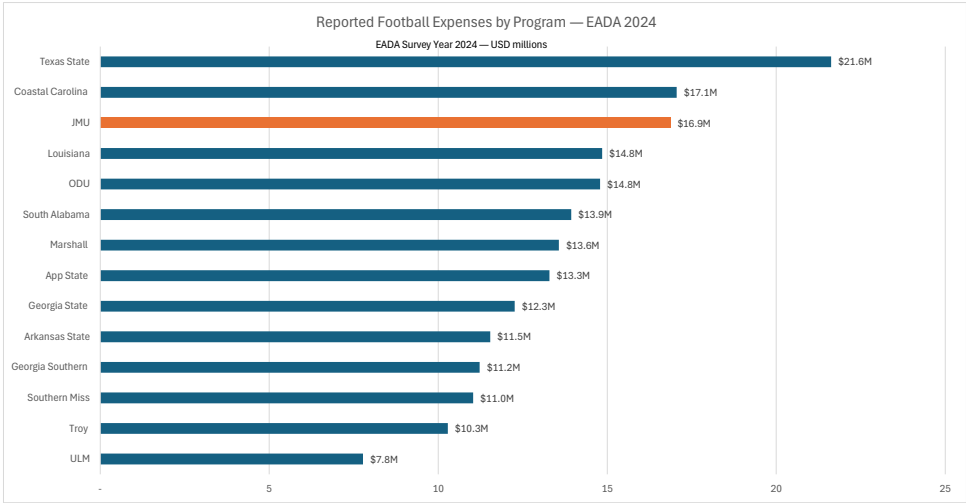




Sun Belt Football Spending and Performance — Methodology & Sources

1. Research Question

Which Sun Belt football programs achieved the strongest on-field performance relative to their reported spending during the 2023 season?

2. Scope

Conference	Sun Belt Conference
Programs analyzed	14 football programs
Football season	2023
Financial dataset	EADA Survey Year 2024
Financial period	Broadly corresponding to July 2023–June 2024
Conference composition	2023 Sun Belt membership: Texas State included; Louisiana Tech excluded

The EADA reporting period broadly overlaps with the 2023 football season. Individual institutions may use slightly different twelve-month reporting periods

3. Raw Variables

Variable	Definition	Source
Football participants	Number of football participants reported by the institution	EADA
Total football expenses	Total reported expenses attributed to the football program	EADA
Overall wins and losses	Final overall 2023 season record, including postseason games	Sun Belt
Conference wins and losses	2023 regular-season Sun Belt record	Sun Belt

4. Calculated Metrics

Metric	Formula
Expenses per participant	Total football expenses / Football participants
Overall win percentage	Overall wins / (Overall wins + Overall losses)
Conference win percentage	Conference wins / (Conference wins + Conference losses)
Wins per \$1M spent	Overall wins / (Total football expenses / 1,000,000)
Conference wins per \$1M spent	Conference wins / (Total football expenses / 1,000,000)

5. Correlation Analysis

Relationship analyzed	Total football expenses vs. conference win percentage
Correlation coefficient	0.41
R ²	0.16

The positive relationship is moderate. The R² value indicates that approximately 16% of the observed linear variation in conference win percentage is associated with differences in reported football spending within this sample. This result is descriptive and does not demonstrate causation.

6. Data Sources			
Source ID	Source	Variables used	Link
FIN-01	U.S. Department of Education — EADA Survey Year 2024	Football participants and total football expenses	EADA official portal
SPORT-01	Sun Belt Conference — 2023 Football Standings	Overall and conference wins and losses	2023 Sun Belt standings
RAW-01	EADA custom data export — Sport_Data_2024.csv	Raw financial dataset retained with the project	Embedded in workbook — Raw Data sheet

7. Limitations
• The analysis covers only one football season. • Overall-season metrics are less directly comparable because programs played different numbers of games due to postseason participation; conference metrics are therefore emphasized in the main analysis. • The analysis covers all 14 Sun Belt football programs but only one conference and one season, limiting generalization to other conferences or years. • Strength of schedule is not controlled. • Injuries, coaching changes and roster quality are not included. • EADA expenses exclude capital expenditures, debt service and certain indirect facility costs, so total reported expenses do not capture every resource available to a football program. • Spending levels may reflect decisions and investments made before the 2023 season. • Wins per \$1M is a descriptive sporting-performance metric, not a financial ROI. • Correlation does not establish that higher spending causes stronger performance. • Reported EADA expenses are annual actual expenditures rather than a preseason budget; postseason participation and other in-season activities may therefore affect total reported spending.

8. Interpretation Guidelines
A higher number of conference wins per \$1 million indicates stronger sporting results relative to reported spending during the analyzed season. It does not necessarily indicate better management, greater profitability or superior long-term program quality. Programs should therefore be compared in terms of reported spending and sporting outcomes, rather than described as financially profitable or inefficient.